

Team EQ Pulse Check

A quick, 10-question team emotional intelligence pulse check — psychological safety, empathy, emotional climate, and collective regulation. Designed for fast, repeatable use, not a deep diagnostic.

How to Use This Pulse Check

- Have each team member rate the 10 statements individually and honestly, 1 (Strongly Disagree) to 5 (Strongly Agree)
- Average scores across the team before discussing results together — this is meant to prompt a team conversation, not just produce a number
- Repeat every 4-6 weeks to track real movement, rather than relying on a single one-off snapshot

The Four Team EQ Dimensions

Dimension	What It Covers
Psychological Safety	Whether team members feel safe admitting mistakes, disagreeing, and asking for help
Empathy	Whether the team notices and responds to what colleagues are actually experiencing
Emotional Climate	The team's overall day-to-day mood, and whether tension gets acknowledged or ignored
Collective Regulation	How the team manages its shared mood under pressure or when something goes wrong

The Pulse Check

Rate each statement: 1 (Strongly Disagree) – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5 (Strongly Agree)

Psychological Safety (Questions 1-3)

1. People on this team feel safe admitting a mistake without fear of it being held against them. ____
2. Team members raise concerns or disagree with the majority view, even when it's uncomfortable. ____
3. Asking for help is seen as normal on this team, not as a sign of weakness. ____

Empathy (Questions 4-5)

4. Team members notice when a colleague is struggling, even if it isn't announced. ____
5. This team makes room for someone's personal circumstances affecting their work, without judgment. ____

Emotional Climate (Questions 6-8)

6. The overall mood of this team, most days, is more energizing than draining. ____
7. Tension or frustration on this team gets acknowledged rather than ignored. ____
8. This team can have a hard day without it souring how people treat each other. ____

Collective Regulation (Questions 9-10)

9. When something goes wrong, this team stays focused on solving it rather than spiraling into blame. ____
10. Under pressure, this team's collective mood stays workable rather than becoming reactive or chaotic. ____

Team Scoring Guide

Dimensions have different numbers of questions, so score by percentage of each dimension's own maximum, not by raw total — this keeps dimensions comparable despite the different question counts.

Dimension	Questions	Max Score	Developing (below 60%)	Solid (60-80%)	Strength (above 80%)
Psychological Safety	1-3	15	Below 9	9-11	12-15
Empathy	4-5	10	Below 6	6-7	8-10
Emotional Climate	6-8	15	Below 9	9-11	12-15
Collective Regulation	9-10	10	Below 6	6-7	8-10

Action Planning Prompts

Use the prompts for whichever dimension scored lowest as your team's discussion starting point.

If Psychological Safety scored lowest

- What's one recent moment where someone might have wanted to disagree or admit a mistake, but didn't?
- What would make it feel genuinely safer to do that here?

If Empathy scored lowest

- Are there signals of someone struggling that this team tends to miss or overlook?
- What's one small, low-cost way this team could check in on each other more consistently?

If Emotional Climate scored lowest

- Is there unspoken tension on this team that everyone can sense but no one has named?
- What's contributing most to the day-to-day mood here, for better or worse?

If Collective Regulation scored lowest

- Think of the last time something went wrong under pressure — did the team stay focused on solving it, or did it spiral?
- What would help this team stay steadier the next time something goes wrong?

Turn the team's discussion into one specific, small commitment before ending the conversation — a pulse check that doesn't lead to any action tends to lose credibility for next time.